Export PC-ACE ACCESS Tables to Excel

Contents

PC-ACE relational database 1
Exporting the tables: How to do it? 2
Data database 2
Userlog database 5
Why bother converting? Three good reasons… 6

PC-ACE relational database

PC-ACE (Program for Computer-Assisted Coding of Events) was developed by Roberto Franzosi (see references) to carry out "quantitative narrative analysis," i.e., the analysis of narrative data in quantitative ways, exploiting the invariant structure of narrative best captured by the 5Ws + H (who, what, when, where, why, and how), already known in ancient rhetoric.



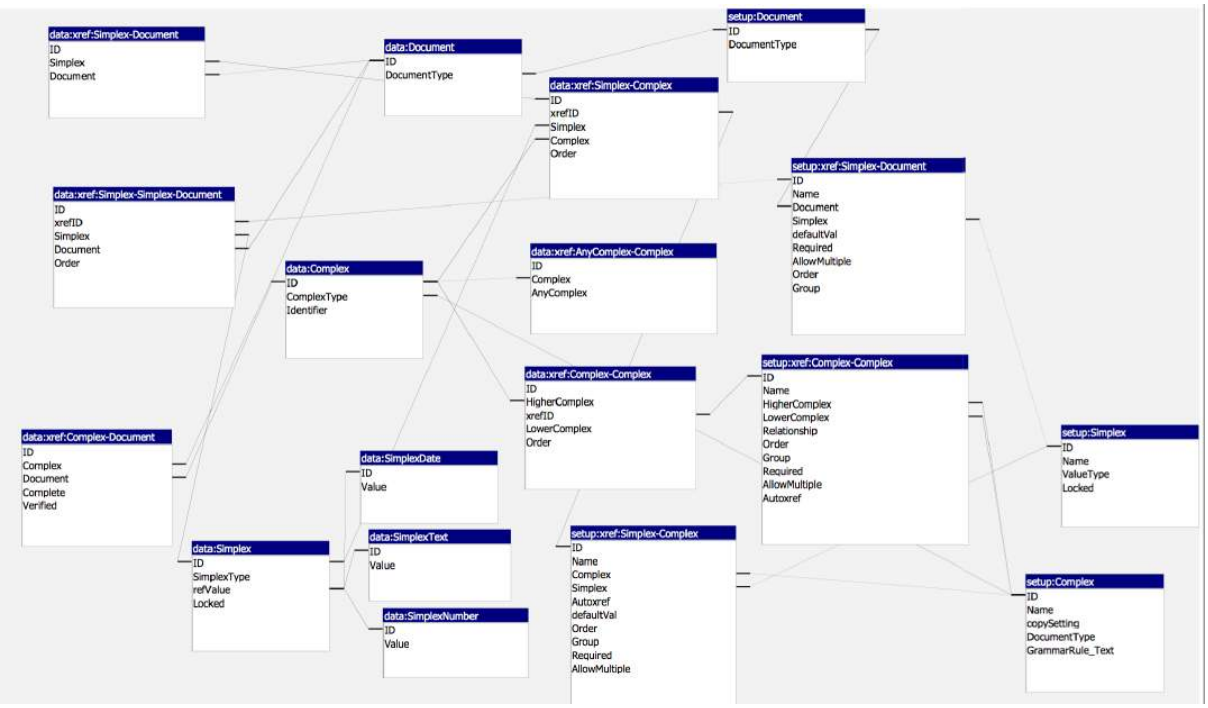
PC-ACE is built on Microsoft Access as a relational database. In fact, it includes two different databases: data and userlog.

Data.mdb

Userlog.mdb

The *data* database is composed of several tables, related to one other (see chart below):

1. 6 setup tables that allowed the user to setup the structure and names of the objects to be used in a specific study, e.g., event, semantic triplet, individual actor;
2. 18 data tables where the information taken from document sources (e.g., newspapers) is stored;
3. 4 utility tables that store various types of information necessary for the database to run.

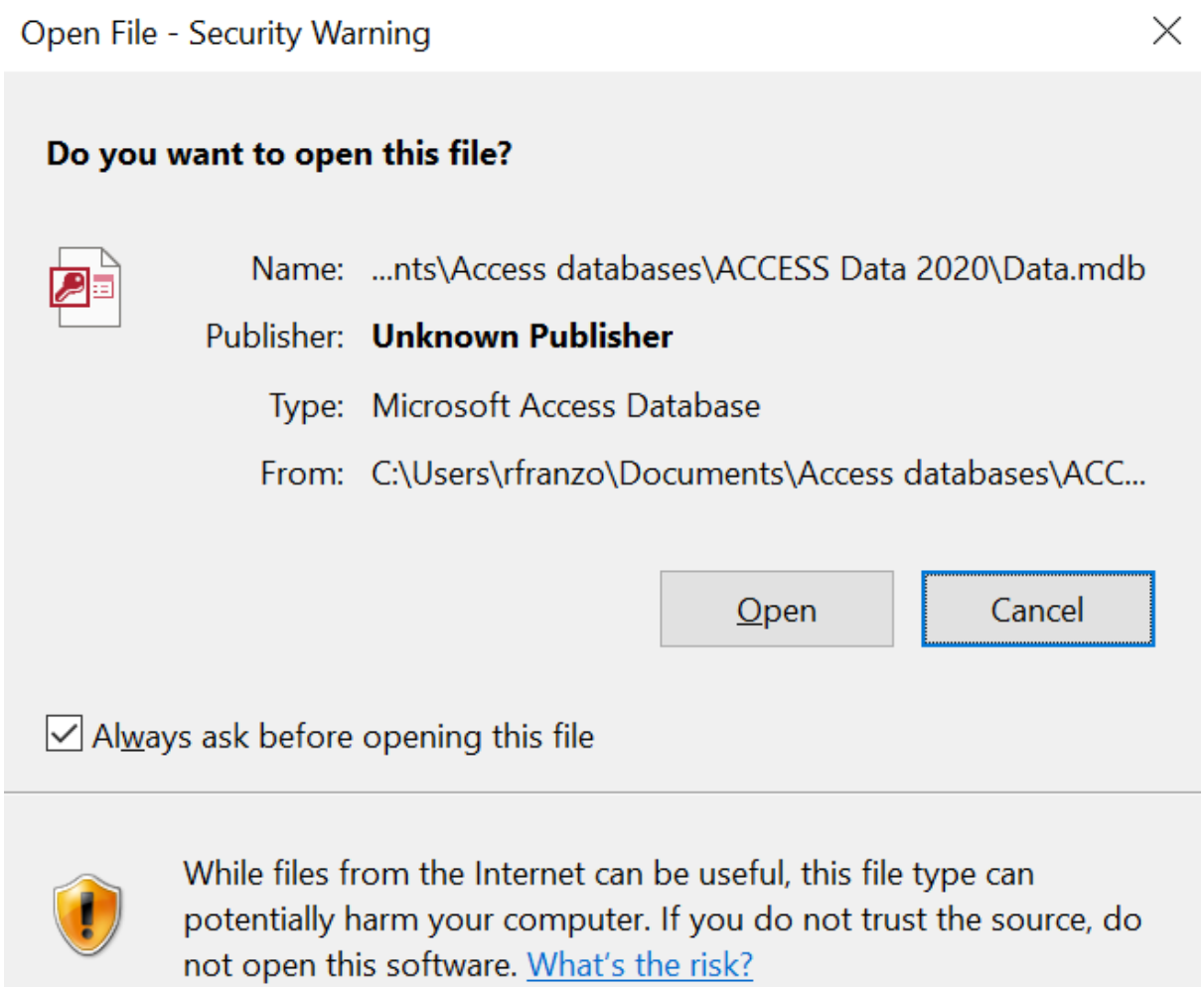


The *userlog* database is composed of 2 tables.

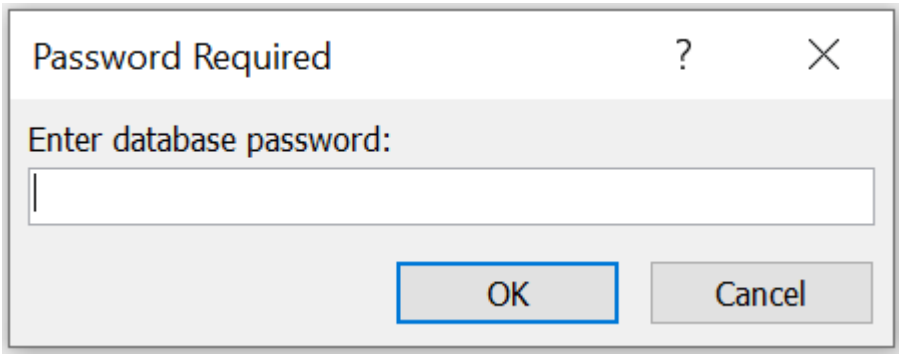
Exporting the tables: How to do it?

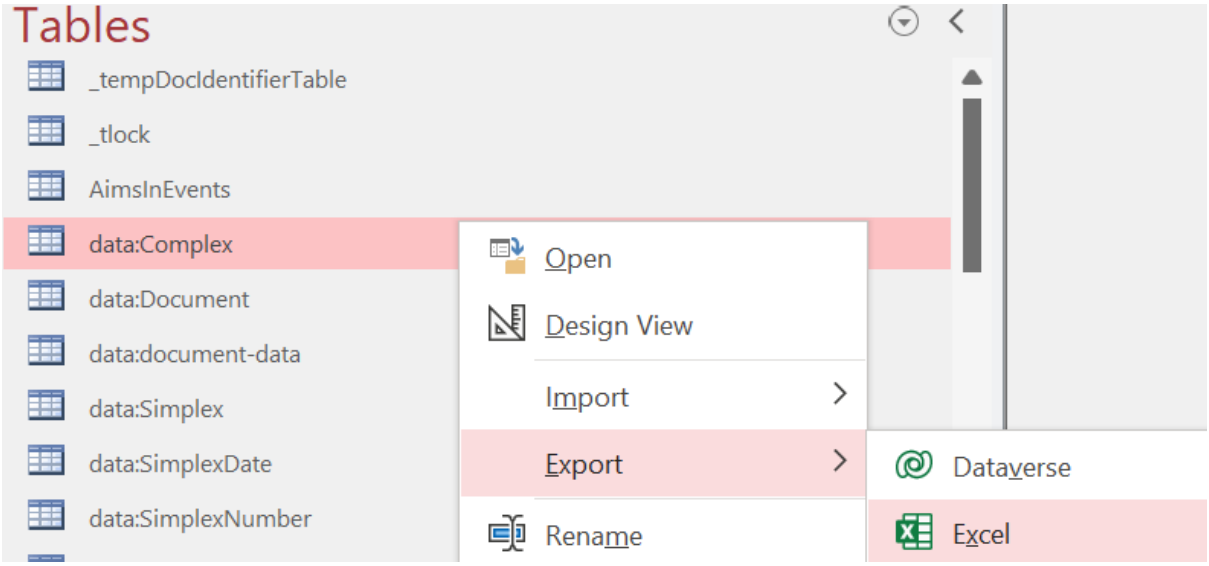
Data database

Click on data.mdb database to open it.

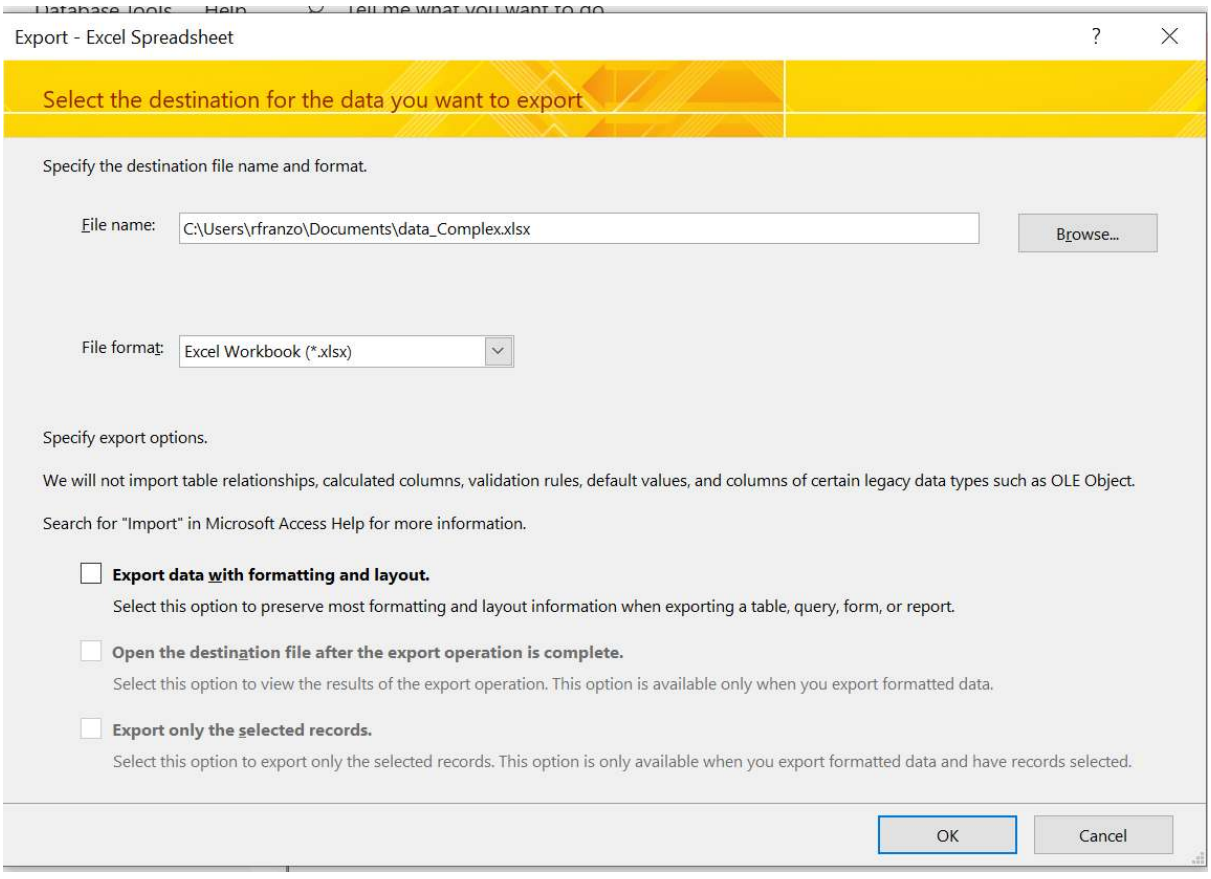


Click on Open holding the Shift key down. When prompted for the **data database password** enter **pcacenarrativedataba**





Select the table to be exported (e.g., data:Complex) and select the Excel option for export. **You will need to repeat this operation for every table in the data database.**



Click OK to save the export to the Excel file.

If you open the Excel file for the data:Complex table it will look something like this (with your data 😊, instead of Franzosi's Georgia lynching project data).

	ID	ComplexType	Identifier
2	2	1	(1 (Zeb Long male black))
3	3	1	(James Cobb male black) 1
4	4	1	(Frank Hardeman male black) 1
5	5	1	(Will Lowe male black) 1
6	6	1	(Owen Jones male black) 1
7	7	1	(1 (Jett Hicks male black))
8	8	1	(1 (Sherman Harris male black))
9	9	1	(W. L. Ryder male white) 1
10	11	1	(1 (Ed — male black))

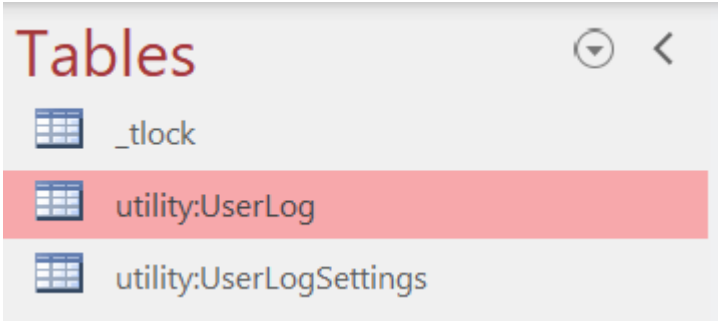
You will need to export to Excel all 18 data tables and 6 setup tables. Of the 4 utility tables you will need to export the utility:Security table.

utility:Security

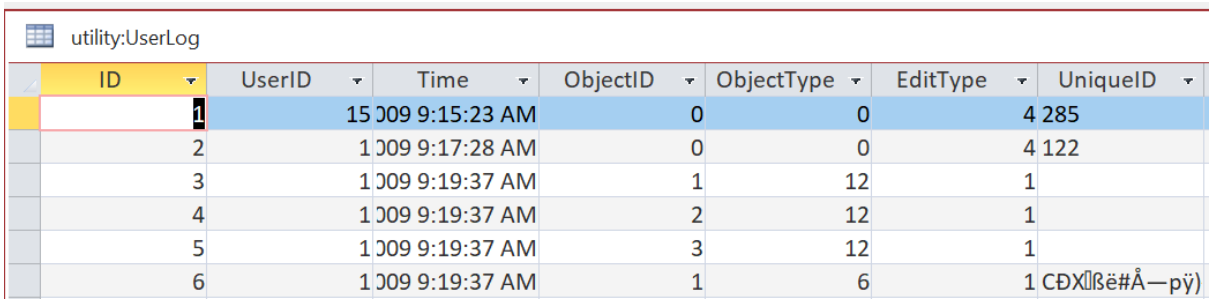
ID	UserName	UserPasswor	Disabled	DateMask	TimeMask	DateTimeMa	UserLevel
1	Stefania	Vicari	☐				Administrator
2	Silvia	Girardi	☐				User
3	Roberto	Giulia	☐				Administrator
4	Gianluca	Ligabue	☐				Administrator
5	Alison	Heslin	☐				Verifier
6	Naveed	Amalfard	☐				User
7	AlisonA	Heslin	☐				Administrator
8	AlisonC	Heslin	☐				User

Userlog database

To open the *Userlog* database, repeat the same operations as for the data database. The Userlog database password is **pcaceuserlogbackend.**



The UserLog database contains 2 tables. The utility:UserLog table stores information on login/logout time for each database user with the types of objects and operations performed.



utility:UserLog

ID	UserID	Time	ObjectID	ObjectType	EditType	UniqueID
1	15	009 9:15:23 AM	0	0	4	285
2	1	009 9:17:28 AM	0	0	4	122
3	1	009 9:19:37 AM	1	12	1	
4	1	009 9:19:37 AM	2	12	1	
5	1	009 9:19:37 AM	3	12	1	
6	1	009 9:19:37 AM	1	6	1	CÐX□ßë#Å—pÿ)

Why bother converting? Three good reasons…

There are two reasons for converting the PC-ACE data to Python.

1. PC-ACE is based on a database developed in Microsoft Access. As a result PC-ACE cannot run in a Mac OS environment. The data stored in a PC-ACE database cannot be analyzed in a Mac OS environment. **If you are a Mac user and have a PC-ACE database to analyze, you would not be able to do it.**
2. PC-ACE has not been supported by Franzosi for some years.
3. Most importantly, **once the PC-ACE database tables are converted to Pandas dataframes in the NLP Suite, a large set of data analysis and data visualization tools available in the NLP Suite can be used**.